LITTLE LAMB 2026–2027 · MEETING 3

God's World Rocks! Requirement: My World I

Sabbath, October 31, 2026 · Ages 4–5 · 60–80 minutes · Leader's Guide pp. 43–48 (closing song p. 175)

What the kids will learn

- **God made the land and the rocks**. On Day 3 He said, "Let the dry land appear!" (Genesis 1:9–10).
- **Rocks are all different:** big and little, smooth and rough, heavy and light, hard and soft, every colour. Some sparkle, and **one kind even floats**.
- We can **explore** God's rocks like scientists: look close, scratch, weigh, drop in water, sort.
- **The wise man built his house on the rock** (Matthew 7:24–27). Building on the rock means listening to Jesus and doing what He says.

Straight from the Leader's Guide (pp. 43–48): Gather the Flock (5) · Lamb Tales "Rocks" (10) · Activities: Building on the Rocks (10), Rock Hunt (10), Geology 101 (10), Rock Sculptures (10) · Good-baa Little Lambs (5). All four activities fulfil **My World I**. The guide's plan totals 60 min. The BOOSTs below stretch it to 80 without adding off-topic games.

The 4 Golden Rules

1. **Switch every 5–7 minutes.**
2. **Loud → quiet → loud.** Rock Hunt is up and moving; Geology centres are hands-on but calm; sand and song are loud again; sculptures settle them before goodbye.
3. **Magic Signal:** "Little Lambs…" → "BAA!" and freeze. It's been **four weeks since Meeting 2**, so re-teach it in minute one.
4. **Everybody does, every time.**

Meeting 3, after a long gap

- **Quick recall first:** "What's a baby sheep called?" (LAMB) "Who is our Good Shepherd?" (JESUS!). They'll be proud to know.
- Today moves from **lambs** to **God's world**. Link it: "*The Good Shepherd made a whole world for His lambs, with grass and water and… ROCKS!*"
- **Rock rule, said at the start and often:** rocks stay in hands and on tables. **Never in mouths, never thrown.** Gravel and small pebbles are a choking risk, so watch the youngest ones.
- Today's one big idea: **"God made the rocks, and He made ME!"**

Schedule: the full 80-minute meeting

I've **re-ordered the guide's four activities** on purpose. **Rock Hunt** comes first, so each child collects their own rocks; they then **explore those rocks** at the Geology centres and **glue them** into their sculpture at the end. Sculptures go last because wet glue and smocks are the calm finish (and glued rocks need the longest to dry). Purple **BOOST** lines fit inside the slot.

TIME	SEGMENT	WHAT YOU ACTUALLY DO
0:00–0:05	Gather the Flock · guide	The **lamb puppet** greets each child by name and welcomes them. Everyone sits in a circle. Re-teach the Magic Signal. **BOOST · What's in the bag?** The mascot is holding a cloth bag (or sock) with **one rock** inside. Pass it round the circle: each child feels it *without looking*. "Is it soft? Hard? Heavy? What could it be?" The last child pulls it out: *"A ROCK! Today we're going to find out all about the rocks God made."*
0:05–0:15	Lamb Tales: "Rocks" · guide	**Pass round a variety of rocks** to see and touch: a big one, a tiny one, a smooth river stone, a rough one, a sparkly crystal, a lava rock. Remind them that **God created the land and the rocks**. Then read **"God Made the Rocks!"** (print **read-aloud-god-made-rocks.pdf**). *Why not the guide's book?* It's *If You Find a Rock* by Peggy Christian (HMH, 2008). It's lovely and still in print, but there's no printable copy.

		The guide says "or a book of your choice". After the story, tell them: **"You'll be doing lots of fun things with the rocks God made today!"** **BOOST · Rock words with actions:** teach five words before you read, then point when one comes up. **Smooth** (stroke your arm) · **rough** (scratch-scratch) · **heavy** (heave-ho!) · **light** (float your hands up) · **sparkly** (twinkle fingers). Then play **Rock Thumbs** on the class app (page 2) for 2 minutes.
0:15–0:27	🔎 Activity 2: Rock Hunt · guide	Before class, **hide polished stones, smooth river rocks and crystals** inside the room (or outside if it's dry). Don't hide them too well, because you want every child to succeed. Give each child a **small bag** (brown lunch bag with a **Rock Treasure label** from **rock-explorer.pdf**, page 2) and send them hunting. **BOOST · Five-rock treasure:** "Find **five** rocks, then come and sit on the rug." Once they're back, count them out loud together, **1-2-3-4-5**, like the five smooth stones David picked from the stream (they heard it in the story). Children who find more give spares to a friend, so nobody ends up with fewer than five. **These are their rocks for the rest of the meeting.**
0:27–0:42	🔬 Activity 3: Geology 101 · guide	**Rock exploration centres**, set up before class with a sign each (**geology-centres.pdf**): **1** Look Close (magnifying glasses) · **2** Scratch Test (hard or soft? **an adult holds the nail**) · **3** Heavy or Light (kitchen scale, rocks about the same size) · **4** Sink or Float (bowls of water + a lava rock, which floats!) · **5** Sort It (by colour onto construction paper, or by size through holes in a shoe-box lid). Small groups with one helper each, **3 minutes per centre**, and ring a bell to rotate. Children test **their own Rock Hunt rocks**. **BOOST · Guess first!** At Sink or Float, every child guesses **before** each drop: thumbs up = floats, thumbs down = sinks. Save the **lava rock for last**, because everyone will say "sink". *"Look! God made a rock that floats!"* With only one or two helpers, run centres 3–5 as a whole group at one table instead, with the app's Sink-or-Float and Colour Sort games (pages 6–7) as backup.
0:42–0:44	***🧼 Hands & Wiggles***	*Towels for wet hands. Rocks back in their bags, with names on the bags. Five "mountain stretches" (tall) and five "pebble crouches" (tiny). Magic Signal to settle.*
0:44–0:59	🏠 Activity 1: Building on the Rocks · guide	**Begin by singing "The Wise Man Built His House Upon the Rock"**, with actions (action cards in **builder-cards.pdf**). Then the children **sift the sand tubs to find the hidden rocks**: you buried polished stones, "fool's gold" and craft crystals in tubs of sand before class. Sieves, colanders, or **oatmeal boxes with holes punched in the bottom** let the sand fall out and keep the rocks. **BOOST · Rain test (before the song, 3 min):** in a baking tray, build one little block house on a **flat rock** and one on a **mound of sand**. Ask: "Which house will stand when the rain comes?" Pour a watering can over both. The sand house slumps and the rock house stands. *"Jesus said: the wise man listens to Me and does what I say. He's like a house on a rock!"* Then sing, then sift. The class app has the same test (page 8) and the 5-card story in order (page 9).
0:59–1:02	***🧼 Sand Off, Smocks On***	*Brush hands over the tub, wipes. Newspaper on the tables, smocks on, everyone sits at the sculpture table with their rock bag.*

1:02–1:14	🎨 **Activity 4: Rock Sculptures** · guide	Each child has a **6 × 6 in (15 × 15 cm) cardboard square**. Glue in **shallow containers** (plastic lids work well). They **glue rocks to the cardboard and to each other**, building with their Rock Hunt rocks, the sand-tub treasures, plus gravel and extra pebbles. They can also **paint the rocks and cardboard with acrylic paint**. Full steps overleaf. **BOOST · Name it!** When it's done, each child gives the sculpture a name and tells the group about it: "This is a mountain." "This is a house on the rock!" Write the name on the cardboard edge. "*God made the rocks, and God made YOU able to make something beautiful with them.*"
1:14–1:20	🎵 **Good-baa Little Lambs** · guide	Circle up. The guide's question: **"What did you learn about rocks?"** Every child gets a turn: big/little, smooth/rough, heavy/light, sink/float, colours. Follow up with **"Who made the rocks?"** and **"Where did the wise man build his house?"** Sing **"Jesus Is My Shepherd"**. Rock bags and take-home slips go home; sculptures stay to dry or go home flat. Rejoin the Adventurers for the closing program. **BOOST · Investiture practice:** sing "Jesus Is My Shepherd" **twice**, once with the **sing-along video** (*investiture-2027/song-singalong.mp4*) and once on their own. After a four-week gap, they'll need it. Finish with one round of **"Come, little lambs!"** → **"BAA!"** from the skit.

The 60-minute cut (the guide's own timing): Gather (5) · Lamb Tales (10) · Rock Hunt (10) · Geology 101 as **one table**, leader-led: magnifier, sink-or-float, sort (10) · Building on the Rocks: song + sift, skip the rain test (10) · Sculptures (10) · Good-baa (5). **Nothing gets dropped**, and all four guide activities still happen.

If you have only one helper: skip the rotating centres. Sit everyone round one table and do each centre **together**, one child at a time doing the action (one scratches, one weighs, one drops a rock in). It's slower per child but calmer, and everyone sees the lava rock float.

🏠 Activity 1 in full: Building on the Rocks guide p. 45, 10 min (+3 min rain test)

Set up before class

1. **Sand tubs:** 2–3 plastic tubs or boxes, half-full of **play sand**. One tub per 3–4 children.
2. **Bury the treasure:** polished stones, smooth river rocks, "**fool's gold**" (gold craft stones), craft **crystals**/gems. Roughly **8 per child**, so everyone finds plenty.
3. **Sifters:** kitchen sieves, colanders, or **oatmeal / round boxes with holes punched in the bottom** with a pencil. Holes must be smaller than the rocks.
4. An old sheet or shower curtain **under the tubs**: sand gets everywhere.
5. **Rain test:** a baking tray, a flat rock, a cup of sand piled in a mound, 8–10 small blocks or Duplo, and a watering can or jug. **Try it at home first** and wet the sand slightly so it holds a shape, then collapses when soaked.

In class: what you say and do

1. Rain test (BOOST): build both houses with two child helpers. "*Which one will stand?*" Pour. The sand house slumps. "*The house on the rock stood strong!*"
2. "*Jesus told a story about two men. The wise man listened to Jesus and built on the rock. The foolish man built on the sand.*" (Matthew 7:24–27.)
3. **Sing "The Wise Man Built His House Upon the Rock"** with the four actions (below). Sing it twice: the second time, faster!
4. "*Now there are rocks hiding in this sand. Let's find them!*" Scoop, shake the sieve, and the sand falls through while the rocks stay.
5. Each find goes into their **Rock Treasure bag**. "Is yours smooth or rough? Sparkly?"

> **Watch out for:** sand thrown or in eyes. Say "sand stays low, in the tub" before you start · scoop, don't dig with elbows · sieves held *over the tub*, never over the floor · keep a hand-brush and dustpan nearby · any child with sand in an eye: rinse with water, don't rub.

Song actions (you'll know the tune; three verses: the wise man, the foolish man, "so build your house on the Lord Jesus Christ"): **"built his house upon the rock"**: fist on flat palm, three taps · **"the rains came down"**: fingers wiggle downwards · **"the floods came up"**: hands rise from the floor · **"the house on the rock stood firm"**: stack fists, strong arms · **"the house on the sand went SPLAT!"**: clap and flop over.

🔬 Activity 3 in full: Geology 101 guide p. 47, 10 min (15 with BOOST)

The five centres (print one sign each from geology-centres.pdf)

1. 🔍 **Look Close.** Magnifying glasses. Ask: "What can you see? Lines? Sparkles? Holes?"
2. 🔨 **Scratch Test.** Scrape rocks with a nail: **a scratch line = soft, no line = hard**. **An adult holds the nail**; the child points to which rock. Chalk or sandstone scratches easily, granite or quartz doesn't. (A coin or steel spoon works if you'd rather not have nails out.)
3. ⚖️ **Heavy or Light.** Kitchen scale. Rocks **about the same size** but different kinds weigh different amounts: a lava rock vs a river stone the same size is perfect. "Hold one in each hand first. Which is heavier?" Then weigh them.
4. 💧 **Sink or Float.** Bowls of water. Guess, then drop. Most rocks sink, but **lava rock floats** because it is full of tiny air holes. (Get it at a garden centre, or use a **pumice stone** from the pharmacy foot-care shelf.)
5. 🎨 **Sort It.** By **colour**: place rocks onto construction paper that matches (grey, black, white, red/brown, pink). Or by **size**: drop them through small, medium and large holes cut into a **shoe-box lid** (template on the last page of geology-centres.pdf).

Running it with 4–5 year olds

- **Groups of 2–4 with one adult each.** 3 minutes per centre; ring a bell and move clockwise. With fewer helpers, use 3 centres, or one big table (see box on page 1).
- Children use **their own Rock Hunt rocks**, which is much more exciting than "the leader's rocks".
- Optional: a **Rock Explorer sheet** (**rock-explorer.pdf**, page 1) per child. They circle big/little, smooth/rough, heavy/light, sink/float for their favourite rock and draw it. Great for a quiet finisher.
- Say it like a scientist: "*You're GEOLOGISTS today. That's a rock scientist!*" They love the big word.

> **Safety:** nails stay with adults · towels under the water bowls · magnifying glasses never pointed at the sun · small rocks and gravel: a choking risk, so no rocks in mouths · rocks are never thrown, only "rolled" to a friend on the table.

🎨 Activity 4 in full: Rock Sculptures guide p. 48, 10 min

Prep before class

1. Cut cardboard into **6 × 6 in (15 × 15 cm) squares**, one per child + spares. A cereal box is too thin; use **shipping-box cardboard**. Write each child's name on the back.
2. Collect rocks **in a variety of sizes, including gravel** (aquarium gravel works well). Mostly **small and flat**, because big round rocks won't stay glued.
3. **Craft glue in shallow containers**: plastic lids work well. Use thick **tacky glue**, not runny school glue. One lid per two children.
4. Acrylic paint in a few colours, brushes, smocks, **newspaper over the whole table**.

In class

1. Dip the **flattest side** of a rock in the glue, press it onto the cardboard, and **hold for a count of 5**.
2. Build up: big rocks at the bottom, little rocks and gravel on top and in the gaps.
3. Paint the rocks and cardboard if they want (acrylic dries fast but **stains clothes**, so smocks on).
4. Name it (BOOST), then lay it **flat** on the drying shelf.

> **Glue reality check:** tacky glue needs a few hours to set. Tall stacks will slide. Tell the children "*it's still drying, carry it flat like a pizza!*" Or keep the sculptures at church until next week. A **low-temp glue gun, used by an adult only**, makes the big pieces hold instantly. Washable tempera is fine instead of acrylic if you worry about clothes.

🛒 Supply List

- [ ] **Lamb puppet** (the class mascot) + a cloth bag or sock
- [ ] **A variety of rocks**: big, little, smooth, rough, sparkly, all colours
- [ ] Polished stones / river rocks / craft crystals (Rock Hunt, ~5 per child)
- [ ] Small bags: brown lunch bags or zip bags, 1 per child
- [ ] Read-aloud (print **read-aloud-god-made-rocks.pdf**)
- [ ] **Lava rock** (garden centre) or a **pumice stone** (pharmacy)
- [ ] "Fool's gold" + crystals for the sand (~8 per child)
- [ ] Play sand + 2–3 tubs or boxes + an old sheet underneath

- [ ] Sieves / colanders / oatmeal boxes with holes
- [ ] Magnifying glasses (2–4)
- [ ] Kitchen scale
- [ ] Shoe box (lid with 3 holes) + construction paper in rock colours
- [ ] Gravel + extra small flat pebbles
- [ ] Acrylic (or washable) paint, brushes, scissors
- [ ] A bell (for rotating centres)
- [ ] Laptop or tablet + speaker (class app)
- [ ] Rain test: baking tray, flat rock, small blocks, watering can
- [ ] Nails (adult only), or a coin / steel spoon
- [ ] Bowls of water + towels
- [ ] Cardboard squares 6 × 6 in (15 × 15 cm), 1 per child + spares
- [ ] Tacky craft glue + plastic lids
- [ ] Smocks, newspaper, baby wipes, dustpan & brush
- [ ] Printouts: centre signs, explorer sheets/labels, builder cards, slips
- [ ] Phone charged: photos of the geologists!

Where to get it quickly: Dollarama (decorative stones, glass gems, gold craft stones, magnifying glasses, lunch bags, tacky glue) · Canadian Tire / Home Depot (play sand, lava rock in the garden section) · pharmacy (pumice stone) · pet store (aquarium gravel).

📋 Prep Checklist

- [ ] Print lesson plan, read-aloud, centre signs, explorer sheets, builder cards, slips
- [ ] Buy/collect rocks, lava rock, sand, gravel, crystals
- [ ] **Test the rain-test** at home: sand house falls, rock house stands
- [ ] Punch holes in the oatmeal boxes / cut the shoe-box lid
- [ ] Arrive **25 min early**: hide the Rock Hunt rocks, bury treasure in the sand, set out 5 centres + signs
- [ ] Print the shoe-box hole template at **100% scale, margins None**
- [ ] **Test: does your lava rock float?** (Some garden lava rock is too dense; pumice always floats)
- [ ] Cut cardboard squares; names on the back
- [ ] Rock Treasure labels taped on the lunch bags
- [ ] Test **class-app.html** full screen; type in the mascot's name

🎮 Games Toolbox: all on-topic, pull one out any time the energy drops

🏔️ Mountain or Pebble?
You call "MOUNTAIN!", and everyone stretches up tall on tiptoe. "PEBBLE!", and they curl up tiny. Speed it up, then try "BOULDER!" (big and round) and "SAND!" (wiggle all over). The day's best energy burner.

🧺 Feely Bag
The Gather-the-Flock bag, again. Put in a rock, a sponge, a feather or a crystal. One child feels and describes: "It's hard… bumpy… heavy." Everyone guesses.

🪨 Hot Rock
Like hot potato: pass a smooth rock round the circle while music plays. When it stops, the child holding it says one rock word: big, smooth, heavy, grey…

👍 Rock Thumbs
"God made the rocks!" 👍 "Rocks are soft like pillows!" 👎 "Some rocks float!" 👍 On the class app, page 2.

🏠 Wise or Foolish?
Two hoops or tape squares: "ROCK" and "SAND". Call "Build on the rock!" and they jump into the rock square. Call "Here comes the rain!" and anyone on the sand flops down. Then everyone back to the rock.

🔢 David's Five Stones
Five smooth stones in a line. Count together. Eyes closed, and you hide one. "How many now? Which one is missing?" Then go and find it.

🎨 Colour Line-Up
Lay 6–8 rocks in a row from lightest colour to darkest, or smallest to biggest. Children take turns placing the next rock.

🚦 Freeze Like a Rock
Music on: skip like happy lambs. Music off: FREEZE as still as a rock! Anyone who wobbles is a "pebble rolling downhill".

📝 Teacher Cheat Sheet

Three questions for Good-baa (the guide asks one; add two)

1. **"What did you learn about rocks?"** Some are big, some little; smooth or rough; heavy or light; lots of colours; some float!
2. **"Who made the rocks?"** God! On Day 3, when He made the dry land.
3. **"Where did the wise man build his house?"** On the ROCK! It stood strong in the rain.

Rock words (say them with actions)

- 🪶 **smooth**: *stroke your arm* · 🌵 **rough**: *scratch-scratch*
- 🏋️ **heavy**: *heave-ho!* · 🎈 **light**: *float hands up*
- 🏔️ **big**: *arms wide* · 🤏 **little**: *pinch fingers*
- 💎 **sparkly**: *twinkle fingers* · 💧 **sink / float**: *hands down / hands bob*

The Bible behind it

Genesis 1:9–10: on Day 3 God gathered the waters and said "Let dry ground appear." God called it land, and saw it was good.
1 Samuel 17:40: David chose five smooth stones from the stream (links back to Meeting 2's David story).
Matthew 7:24–27: the wise man built his house on the rock; the foolish man built on the sand.
Psalm 18:2: "The LORD is my rock."
Psalm 95:4: "The mountain peaks belong to him."

The one sentence to repeat all morning

🪨 **God made the rocks, and He made ME!**

Simple rock facts, if they ask

Mountains are giant rocks · sand is rock broken into teeny-tiny pieces · river stones are smooth because water rubbed them for a long, long time · lava rock floats because it's full of tiny air bubbles · crystals sparkle because their sides are flat and shiny, like little mirrors.

> **Tips for 4–5s:** let each child test *their own* rocks, as ownership keeps them focused · a child who won't share the magnifier: "Count to 10, then pass it" · if a sculpture falls apart, that's fine: "Let's build it on the rock this time!"

🎵 "Jesus Is My Shepherd": the closing song Mark Wakefield, arr. Joann Herrington · Leader's Guide p. 175

I'm a little lamb today;
Jesus is my Shepherd.
My Shepherd loves me day to day;
Jesus is my Shepherd.
I will follow where He leads;
He gives me everything I need;
I'm a little lamb today,
Jesus is my Shepherd.

Actions: "little lamb": crouch small · "Shepherd": hook your arm like a staff · "loves me": hands on heart · "follow where He leads": march on the spot · "everything I need": open hands. The song sheet is in the Meeting 1 folder.